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CSC 192

April 14, 2025

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CSC-192 Seminar #9: An Unexpected Career Path
Speaker: Richard Layne, IT Leader

Q1: Describe the Role of an Effective IT Manager?

According to the speaker, the most important job of an IT manager is not just to focus on deliverables but to attract, develop, and retain talent. Firstly, Rich emphasized that a manager should care deeply about the growth and success of their team members, even if it means helping them move to other roles outside the team. Secondly, an effective IT manager should shield their team from unnecessary distractions and fight for the resources they need to succeed. In addition, they should take full responsibility when something goes wrong but give all the credit to their team when things go well. Finally, Rich shared how rewarding it feels to see someone grow under his leadership and eventually reach their dream role.

Q2: What are the key elements of running an effective Meeting?

While watching the seminar, I learned that Rich Lane had some very practical advice about meetings. According to the Lane, an effective meeting should always have an agenda so that everyone knows what is going to be discussed. Secondly, meetings should start and end on time, respecting everyone's schedule. In addition, Rich mentioned that it’s important to allow time for open discussion and questions during the meeting. On the other hand, he also pointed out that if a meeting turns out not to be useful for you, it's okay to leave it. Finally, he emphasized that meetings should be efficient and focused, not just gatherings where people waste time.

Q3: What are good skills to have for a long-lasting IT Career?

In this seminar, I understood that a long-lasting IT career needs more than just technical skills. According to the speaker, firstly, it is crucial to love the work itself and always be curious and open to learning new things. Rich explained that constant learning, like picking up new programming languages or understanding design patterns, is necessary. In addition, he highlighted that teamwork is essential because no one works alone in the IT industry. But also, it

is not just about technical growth but also about building good communication skills. Finally, he said that those who succeed are always those who are willing to keep improving and adapting.

Q4: List 3 traits an employee should possess to be successful in an organization.

Firstly, according to the speaker, an employee must always show up, meaning be dependable and consistent without exceptions. He said you must do the work to the best of your ability every time, even when things are tough or when no one is watching. In addition, Rich stressed the importance of getting along with others, meaning being respectful, helpful, and easy to work with. However, he warned that it's not just about doing one or two of these sometimes, you have to commit to doing all three, always. These traits are what truly separate standout employees from everyone else in the organization.

Q5: List the important elements which would help you standout in a Job Interview?

Firstly, you need to demonstrate that you have done more than just attend school and get good grades. Secondly, he explained that employers look for people who have done something extra, like internships, personal projects, or volunteering. In addition, Rich said that passion for the field should be obvious, like building a game on your own if you want to work in gaming. However, he also mentioned that you need to show growth, curiosity, and genuine interest during the interview. Finally, he pointed out that having meaningful questions prepared for the interviewer shows engagement and can really set you apart.

Q6: List 5 questions you would plan to ask during a job interview process?

I would ask, "Can you describe the culture of your organization?" to understand if I would fit in. Secondly, I would ask, "What does a typical day in this role look like?" so I can picture myself in the job. In addition, I would ask, "What are the advancement opportunities available in this company?" to show that I am thinking long term. Another question I would ask is, "What do you value most in an employee?" which can tell me how to succeed if I get the job. Finally, I would ask, "How is success measured for this role?" to clearly understand expectations from the beginning.